

Bouncing Back After a Layoff

Taking the blow, then getting back up

4 psychology approaches · tips & resources — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

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1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Taking the blow, then getting back up

A layoff is a shock: anger, shame, loss of bearings, doubt about your worth — even when it's not your fault. It's normal to need time.

This guide supports you in moving through the shock, remembering your worth, and getting back up — to make it a turning point, not an end.

Your intention

What weighs on you most since the news: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

The identity shock

When work holds a big part of your identity, losing it shakes far more than an income: it's a real grief, mixed with anger and sometimes unjustified shame.

Naming this shock lets you move through it instead of denying it.

Example

Marc defined himself by his role; losing it first stunned him. Understanding the grief helped him not judge himself.

What I'm going through

Write, without judging yourself, all the emotions since the news (anger, shame, fear...).

What I'm really losing

Beyond salary, what do you miss (bearings, status, social connection)?

→ *This shock is legitimate grief — I'm allowed to need time.*

The thoughts that drag you down

'It's my fault', 'I won't find another', 'I'm a failure': generalization turns an event into a verdict on your whole self.

Softening them keeps you from sinking and able to act.

Example

Sure she was 'finished', Nia listed her skills and past wins. The spiral broke.

Thoughts journal

Note: the thought dragging you down · a fairer, kinder version.

A layoff ≠ your worth

Write why a layoff (often tied to context) doesn't judge your worth.

→ *A layoff isn't a verdict on my worth.*

Remembering your worth

You're worth far more than the role you lost: your skills, qualities, experience remain. Rebuilding a fair image of yourself is the basis of the bounce-back.

Who you are wasn't taken away with your job.

Example

Rereading positive feedback received over the years, Léa regained confidence to start again.

My worth, beyond the job

List 5 skills/qualities that remain yours, independent of this role.

My wins

Note 3 work wins you're proud of — they say who you are.

→ *My worth wasn't taken away with my job.*

Getting back up concretely

Concretely: learn your rights and severance, give yourself time to breathe before rushing, take stock of what you want, activate your network, and craft your story (how you'll talk about it).

And build support: if distress lasts, help truly matters.

Example

After learning her rights and breathing for two weeks, Sofia relaunched her search, calm and strategic.

My first steps

Note: learn my rights · give myself X days to breathe · my stock-take (what I want now).

My story

Write in 2-3 sentences, without shame, how you'll present this departure in interviews.

→ *Learn, breathe, build support — and start again, steady.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Give yourself time to take the blow: it's grief, not weakness.
- A layoff (often tied to context) isn't a judgment of your worth.
- Learn your rights and severance.
- Don't rush headlong: take stock of what you truly want.
- Activate your network and craft your story (how you'll talk about it).
- Build support; if distress lasts, don't hesitate to ask for help.

To fill in

What I'm going through

Emotion	What I need

My bounce-back

Step (rights, stock-take, network...)	When

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Welcome the shock, without judging myself.

Week 2 — Soften the thoughts that drag me down.

Week 3 — Remember my worth (beyond the job).

Week 4 — Get back up: rights, stock-take, network, story.

Your plan in 3 lines

- What I allow myself to feel:
- My first concrete step:
- My story for interviews:

TO CLOSE

A layoff isn't an end — you can bounce back.

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This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.